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Java Developer

SCENARIO-BASED INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

virtusa

Question : You use Optional.of(null) and still get NullPointerException.

Answer:

```java
Optional.of(null); // throws NPE
Optional.ofNullable(null); // safe
```

⚠️ **Common Struggles:**

- Developers confuse Optional.of() vs Optional.ofNullable()
- Don't check for null before wrapping in Optional

Question : Why does this return false?

Answer:

- Integer caching only works for -128 to 127
- Use .equals() to compare wrapper objects

```java
Integer a = 128;
Integer b = 128;
System.out.println(a == b); // false
```

⚠️ **Common Struggles:**

- Misuse == for object comparison

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Question : Can a final reference object be mutated?

Answer:

```java
final List<String> list = new ArrayList<>();
list.add("A"); // ✅ Allowed
list = new ArrayList<>(); // ❌ Not allowed
```

⚠️ Common Struggles:

- Think final means immutable
- It's the reference, not the object itself

Question : You accidentally fall through multiple cases in a switch block.

Answer:

- Always use break unless intentional
- Or use Java 14+ switch expressions:

```java
switch (status) {
  case "START" -> start();
  case "STOP" -> stop();
}
```

⚠️ Common Struggles:

- Forget break, leading to subtle bugs

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Question : You're confused why your static variable is null even though it's initialized.

Answer:

```java
static String msg = "Hello";
static {
    msg = msg.toUpperCase(); // may fail if msg declared below
}
```

⚠️ Common Struggles:

- Don't understand class loading order
- Static blocks execute in order of appearance

Question :You clone an object but changes in the clone reflect in the original.

Answer:

- Use deep cloning (clone() is shallow by default)
- Override clone method or use serialization or copy constructors

⚠️ Common Struggles:

- Think .clone() copies everything
- Leads to hidden side effects

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Question : You didn't know enums can have fields, constructors, and methods.

Answer:

```java
enum Status {
  ACTIVE("A"), INACTIVE("I");

  private String code;
  Status(String code) { this.code = code; }

  public String getCode() { return code; }
}
```

⚠️ **Common Struggles:**

- Use enums as constants only
- Don't leverage enum capabilities fully

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Question : Static method in child class doesn't override the parent version.

Answer:

```java
Parent.show(); // Parent's method
Child.show(); // Child's method
```

⚠️ **Common Struggles:**

- Expect dynamic dispatch on static methods
- Leads to confusion in inheritance and testing

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Question : Can you write logic in interface methods?

Answer:
Yes — since Java 8:

```java
default void log() {
  System.out.println("Log");
}
```

⚠️ **Common Struggles:**

- Think interfaces can't have implementation
- Don't know about default and static methods in interfaces

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Question : This code compiles but throws ArrayStoreException at runtime:

Answer:

```java
Object[] objArr = new String[5];
objArr[0] = 10; // ❌ Runtime error
```

⚠️ **Common Struggles:**

- Assume arrays are type-safe because they compile
- Don't realize arrays are covariant; generics are invariant

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Question : You implement Singleton with double-checked locking but still see threading issues.

Answer:

```java
private static Singleton instance;

public static Singleton getInstance() {
  if (instance == null) {
    synchronized(Singleton.class) {
      if (instance == null) {
        instance = new Singleton();
      }
    }
  }
  return instance;
}
```

⚠️ Common Struggles:

- Think double-checking is enough
- Miss volatile, causing visibility issues

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